

295 Catch some tadpoles

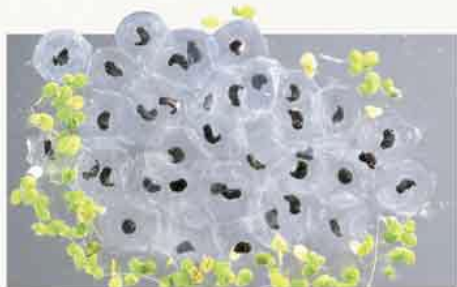
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Tadpoles are the first life stage of frogs and toads. The most common are frog tadpoles, hatched from eggs (spawn) laid in spring. Look for them in nearby ponds or ditches.



You will need

- Fine-mesh net (like a minnow or aquarium net)
- Jar
- Plastic container
- Magnifying glass



1 When they are laid, the eggs are surrounded by a cloudy jelly. Frogs lay eggs in clumps, and toads lay eggs in strings.



2 Put some pond water in the jar and container. Look for tadpoles among the water weeds.

Spot the tadpole!



3 Put the net in the water under the tadpoles and swiftly lift it up. Quickly put them in the jar, then into the container.



296 How old is your tadpole?

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Tadpoles become frogs or toads in 16 weeks. After six weeks, tiny back legs appear. By nine weeks, the arms bud and the tadpole looks more like a frog. The tail shrinks to a stump by 12 weeks.

Long back legs

Still has tail



TEN-WEEK-OLD TADPOLE